Jonathan Pulsifer

securing the cloud since it was just someone else's computer

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SUMMARY

Hi, I'm Jonathan Pulsifer, a **security engineer** who fits into the Staff Engineer Tech Lead & Architect archetypes. I enjoy working with Open Source, **Google Cloud Platform**, **Kubernetes**, and **Containers**. Some might call me a **sysadmin**, some might call me a **DevOps** engineer, but I just like computers.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

2026–CURRENT

ElevenLabs

Security Engineer
I'm a Security Engineer at ElevenLabs, working on infrastructure security.

2021–2026

MoonPay

2026

Principal Infrastructure & Cloud Security Engineer
I was the Principal Infrastructure & Cloud Security Engineer at MoonPay, leading the technical implementation of MoonPay's infrastructure and cloud security.

Engineering Manager
I was the Engineering Manager for MoonPay's **Site Reliability Engineering** and **Cloud Security** teams. I was responsible for the hiring, onboarding, development, and performance management of the teams, as well as their day-to-day operations, technical direction, vendors, and the overall security posture of MoonPay's infrastructure.

POSITIONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

- Primary engineer for MoonPay's cloud platform architecture and security
- Security policy owner, and lead for **SOC 2**, **PCI DSS**, and other governance, risk, and compliance work
- Hands-on owner of business continuity and disaster recovery
- Onboarded acquired companies' infrastructure through mergers and acquisitions
- Just-in-time privileged access management in Google Cloud
- Deployed an internal service catalog
- Steward of MoonPay's most sensitive environments
- **Moonshot Award** recipient
- Hackathon winner with the Latency Llamas

2016–2021

Shopify

Staff Infrastructure Security Engineer
I spent the majority of my time at Shopify on the **Infrastructure Security** team, where I was the engineering lead. My teams were responsible for reducing the blast radius of Shopify's applications and services in production and cared about things like:

- Containers and Kubernetes
- Identity and Access Management
- Infrastructure as Code
- Multi-tenancy Security
- Secure Software Supply Chains

POSITIONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineering lead for **Cloud Security** during the cloud migration

- kubeaudit inventor
- **Production Engineering Hackdays 2018** (1st place)
- Quoted in the Google Cloud Blog when Grafeas launched
- Artisanal just-in-time permissions management with `sudo` for the cloud
- Powered Shopify's Support Quality Assurance system with Google Workspace Add-ons and a little bit of BigQuery
- … and many more!

2008–2015

Canadian Armed Forces

I retired from the Canadian Armed Forces a Master Sailor working as what's now called a Cyber Operator. I was a course developer for and the instructor of a computer network defence course, as well as a Senior Surveillance Analyst – I would describe this as being a team lead at a super spoopy SOC.

Canadian Forces Network Operations Centre

2012–2015

Senior Surveillance Analyst

Technical lead for a group of surveillance analysts – providing focus and direction on computer security incident response, and incident handling on one of the largest computer networks in Canada.

Responsible for anomaly detection, network intrusion detection systems, alert triage, escalation of malware, botnet, and rookit behaviour. Engineered custom tools to increase the unit's capability and assist in the generation of metadata. Produced end product reports, briefings, and incident reports.

POSITIONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

Commander Canadian Forces Information Operations Group Commendation
"[…] His initiative, professionalism, and the ongoing benefits that have arisen from his leadership within Op ENVELOPE have brought great credit upon himself, his Unit, and the Formation."

CFNOC Member of the Year (2014–2015)
"Presented on behalf of the Canadian Forces Network Operations Centre for exceptional dedication, fellowship and professionalism to both the Unit and the Canadian Armed Forces from 1st Jul 2014 to 30th Jun 2015. All of these highly respected attributes have been witnessed on a daily basis and serve to motivate those around him. He epitomizes the highest standards that CFNOC adheres to and strives to help his peers achieve these same standards. Jonathan Pulsifer has been a true representative of CAF values and ethics and is held in the highest regard by co-workers and supervisors alike."

Commanding Officer's Coin
Received for dedication to the unit and professional development during personal hours.

Canadian Forces School of Communications and Electronics

2012–2015

Lead Instructor – Computer Network Defence Analyst

Employed as lead developer and instructor for the Computer Network Defence Analyst (CNDA) course. The four week CNDA course was created in order to provide basic level knowledge and skills required to be employed as a network analyst in the conduct of Defensive Cyber Operations (DCO). The CNDA course is comprised of two main sections.

The first section is intended to provide a fundamental understanding of the cyber environment in which the analyst operates and tools of the trade. The second section shifts focus to introduce students to the tradecraft of traffic analysis that enables the analyst to understand and identify when and how a given security posture has been compromised.

2010–2011

Building Security NCM

Responsible to the Building Security NCO, duties included physical security and access control for a secure building and multiple SCIFS, classified publication accessibility, pass control and access control list management.

Canadian Army Doctrine and Training Centre HQ

2009–2010 **Database Administrator**
Responsible for the creation and maintenance of a secure, distributed, relational database and front end which assisted in the management of over 100 personnel at the Directorate of Army Training. The database included functions such as mail merge, report generation, historical vacation day tracking, and updated positional information sourced from other intranet APIs.

2015 **SANS Institute**
While still in the Navy, in 2015 I started to get involved with the SANS Institute as a mentor and co-instructor for SEC401 and SEC503. I also proctored exams for candidates in the National Capital Region, but fell off after joining Shopify.

COMMUNITY, MEMBERSHIPS, & VOLUNTEERING

Whenever I have enough spoons left I like to give back to the community. Right now, I identify as a:

- Google Cloud Champion Innovator
- Kubernetes Product Security Committee emeritus member
- GIAC Advisory Board member

Previously, as a Google Developer Expert and Kubernetes community person, I hosted and participated in Google Developer Group chapters and Cloud Native Computing Foundation meetups:

- CNCF Ottawa
- GDG Cloud Ottawa
- GDG Cloud Montreal

Here are some places where I've "kept the lights on" during times of digital transformation.

- Law Needs Feminism Because
- National Association of Women and the Law
- Taing Jewellers

COURSES, COMPETITIONS, TRAINING, AND EDUCATION

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)
- LFS258: Kubernetes Fundamentals
- LFS158x: Introduction to Kubernetes
- SANS Canadian CyberTalent Competition (1st place)
- BSides Ottawa 2015 Capture the Flag Competition (2nd place)
- SEC401: Security Essentials: Bootcamp Style
- SEC503: Intrusion Detection In-Depth
- SANS Mentor Training
- Intrusion Detection and Extrusion Analysis Skills
- Computer Network Defence Analyst
- Short Course in Networks and Security
- Instructor Supervisor
- Advanced Instructional Techniques
- Basic Instructional Techniques

TALKS

- Compliant Infrastructure as Code
- Container Security Summit 2018 Keynote
- Infrastructure Security 2.0
- Keyless Entry: Securely Access GCP Services From Kubernetes
- Securing Shopify's PaaS on GKE
- Securing the Software Supply Chain

PUBLICATIONS

- How Shopify Governs Containers at Scale with Grafeas and Kritis
- CEVO Client Information Disclosure